

Interview 07: Student at KV IISc (Mathikere Resident)

Interviewee Context: Grade 10 student at Kendriya Vidyalaya IISc; lives in the Mathikere interior.

Geographic Scope: Focuses on the Mathikere Alley Network and the Subedarchatram Road junction bottleneck.

Audit Note: Subject identifies the “Alley Effect”—where construction detours force heavy traffic into narrow, non-sidewalk residential lanes.

QUESTION 1

Q: Living in Mathikere and attending school at IISc, your commute is geographically very short. How do you find the walk from your house to the campus gate?

A: On a map, it’s just a ten-minute walk, but in reality, it’s the most stressful ten minutes of my day. I have to navigate the narrow Mathikere alleys where there is absolutely no space for a person. You’re always sharing a two-meter lane with bikes and autos. It’s not a “walk”; it’s a constant game of moving out of someone’s way.

QUESTION 2

Q: Describe the “Pedestrian Environment” within these Mathikere alleys. Do you ever see a dedicated walking path there?

A: Footpaths don’t exist in the alleys. It’s just a shared surface. Even when I reach the main Subedarchatram Road, the footpaths are either used as parking or blocked by shop displays. You spend 90% of the time walking on the asphalt, looking over your shoulder to see if a vehicle is too close to your bag.

QUESTION 3

Q: The audit has flagged severe waterlogging in the Mathikere region. What happens to your route after a typical evening downpour?

A: It’s the worst part of living here. The water doesn’t clear for three or four days. It’s stagnant, black sewage water that pools right where you need to step. Because the lanes are so narrow, you can’t go around the puddles. I’ve arrived at school with mud splashed up to my knees so many times. It’s embarrassing to sit in class like that.

QUESTION 4

Q: As you approach the IISc gate, the environment shifts dramatically. How does that contrast affect you?

A: It’s jarring. One minute I’m in Mathikere—honking, dust, and the smell of stagnant water—and the next minute, I’m inside the campus where it’s quiet and clean. It’s like crossing a border. I usually need a few minutes once I’m inside the gate just to “decompress” from the chaos of the Mathikere side before I start my morning classes.

QUESTION 5

Q: Have you observed any specific safety hazards at the Mathikere junction during your morning walk?

A: The junction is where all the friction happens. Autos take sharp turns into the alleys without checking for pedestrians. Since there are no ramps, I see people with bags or

cycles struggling to get onto the higher ground. Also, the dust at the junction is so high that I feel like I've been breathing in exhaust fumes the whole morning.

QUESTION 6

Q: How do the construction-related detours in the area impact your walk?

A: When they block a main road for work, all the traffic spills into our residential alleys. Suddenly, a quiet path becomes a shortcut for fifty motorcycles and delivery vans. As a pedestrian, you get pushed against the walls. There is zero respect for a person's "right to walk" in these situations.

QUESTION 7

Q: Do you ever find yourself taking an auto just to cross this short distance during the monsoon?

A: Yes, when the water is too deep to hop over. It feels like a waste of money because the distance is so short, but I can't walk into school with sewage on my uniform. It's basically a "bad infrastructure tax" that we have to pay just to reach the campus gate.

QUESTION 8

Q: If you could tell the ward engineer one thing about the Mathikere-IISc connection, what would it be?

A: Fix the drainage levels. If the water doesn't clear, the path will always be broken. And please, just give us a clear, continuous walking line to the IISc gate. We shouldn't have to play a game of "survival" every morning just to go to school.

Closing Remark

After the interview, the student navigated through a narrow alley, stepping carefully to avoid a patch of stagnant water. The stark difference between the institutional discipline of the IISc campus and the neglected infrastructure of the Mathikere residential fringe remains the defining feature of this specific commuter's daily reality.